

CASE SUMMARY REPORT: GODHRA RAILWAY POLICE STATION FIR

Historical Fact Summary: This document compiles legally documented facts from the official investigative records, including the Godhra Railway Police FIR No. 9/2002 and subsequent judicial commission findings regarding the Sabarmati Express train burning on February 27, 2002.

1. Primary FIR Registration Details

Parameter	Official Case Details
FIR Number	CR No. 9 / 2002
Police Station	Godhra Railway Police Station, Gujarat
Date of Incident	February 27, 2002
Approximate Time	08:03 AM IST
Place of Occurrence	Near 'A' Cabin, Godhra Railway Station Yard
Primary Affected Asset	Coach S-6, Ahmedabad-bound Sabarmati Express (Train No. 9166)

2. Narrative Outline of the Incident (As Filed)

The Sabarmati Express, coming from Ayodhya, departed Godhra Railway Station shortly after 8:00 AM. Immediately after leaving the platform, the emergency chain was pulled, bringing the train to a halt near the 'A' Cabin.

According to the initial FIR and subsequent judicial briefs, an aggressive mob of local residents gathered around the stranded train. The crowd began pelting heavy stones at the coaches, particularly targeting coach S-6, preventing passengers from exiting safely.

The mob forced open the vestibule of coach S-6 and poured a highly inflammable substance (petrol) inside. The coach was subsequently set ablaze, resulting in an intense fire that quickly engulfed the entire compartment.

3. Casualties and Immediate Impact

The attack resulted in catastrophic loss of life and heavy injuries inside the enclosed coach. The finalized statistics verified through subsequent investigative bodies are detailed below:

Metric	Count / Status
Fatalities	59 individuals (including 29 men, 25 women, and 5 children)
Injured	48 individuals documented with varying degrees of burns and trauma
Victim Profile	Predominantly Hindu pilgrims (Kar Sevaks) returning from Ayodhya

4. Judicial Commission & Court Rulings

The investigation initiated by FIR No. 9/2002 transitioned through multiple high-level legal bodies over the subsequent decades:

- **The Nanavati-Mehta Commission:** Appointed to probe the incident, the judicial commission concluded in its report that the burning of the S-6 coach was not an accident but a pre-planned criminal conspiracy.
- **Special SIT Court & High Court Verdicts:** In March 2011, a special Special Investigation Team (SIT) court convicted 31 individuals for their involvement in the conspiracy and murder. In October 2017, the Gujarat High Court reviewed the appeals, upholding the conviction of the 31 accused while commuting 11 death sentences to life imprisonment.